Lara Karki

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EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology, Ph.D. Candidate, Human-Centered Computing Aug 2022 – est. May 2027

- *Dissertation:* "Broadening Pathways in Computing"
- *Advisor:* Besty DiSalvo
- *Committee:* Tawanna Dillahunt, Becki Grinter, Judith Uchidiuno, Bhumika Chauhan

School of the Museum of Fine Arts at Tufts University, Bachelor of Fine Arts, Boston, MA Aug 2009 – May 2011

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Culture and Technology Lab, Graduate Research Assistant, Georgia Institute of Technology Aug 2022 – Present

GRANTS & AWARDS

Foley Scholar Finalist, Institute for People and Technology, Georgia Institute of Technology 2026

Pathbreakers Fellowship ($34,000), Georgia Institute of Technology 2024

Graduate Research Fellowship ($159,000), National Science Foundation 2023

President's Fellowship ($22,000), Georgia Institute of Technology 2022

RESEARCH, SCHOLARSHIP, AND CREATIVE ACTIVITIES

Refereed Publications

Journals

Lara Karki, Kayla Uleah, Carl DiSalvo, Sierra Traynail Ross, Jadin Butler, Selamawit Husein, Emanuel Bryant, Dana Priest, Justin Booker, and Betsy DiSalvo. 2025. "'I get hives when I come on here': Persisting Through Platform-Delivered Microaggressions on LinkedIn." Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact. 9, 7, Article CSCW232 (November 2025), 36 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3757413

Conferences

Lara Karki, Aarti Israni, Kayla Uleah, Tawanna R. Dillahunt, Julie Hui, and Betsy DiSalvo. 2027. "Beyond Users vs. Builders: Reframing Computing Work." Paper presented at GROUP '27. 2027 ACM International Conference on Supporting Group Work (GROUP Companion '27).

Lara Karki, Aarti Israni, Tawanna Dillahunt, Julie Hui, Dana Priest, Asher Brown, and Betsy DiSalvo. 2026. Recognizing, Supporting, and Futuring Diverse Pathways in Computing Work. In Adjunct Proceedings of the 5th Annual Symposium on Human-Computer Interaction for Work (CHIWORK Adjunct '26). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 33, 1–4. https://doi.org/10.1145/3805029.3818267

Lara Karki, Dana Priest, et al. 2025. "A Window into DataWorks: Developing an Integrated Work-Training Curriculum for Novice Adults." In Proceedings of the 56th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education V. 1 (SIGCSETS 2025). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 568–574. https://doi.org/10.1145/3641554.3701826

Carl DiSalvo, Annabel Rothschild, **Lara L. Schenck**, Ben Rydal Shapiro, and Betsy DiSalvo. 2024. When Workers Want to Say No: A View into Critical Consciousness and Workplace Democracy in Data Work. Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact. 8, CSCW1, Article 156 (April 2024), 24 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3637433

Lara L. Schenck and Betsy DiSalvo. 2023. From Data Work to Data Science: Getting Past the Gatekeepers. In Proceedings of the 2023 ACM Conference on International Computing Education Research - Volume 2 (ICER '23), Vol. 2. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 1–2. https://doi.org/10.1145/3568812.3603468

Under Submission

Lara Karki, Hannah Grosswieser, Eureka Wagner-Kobayashi, Ian P. Swift, Michael Muller, Dana Priest, Robert Wolfe, and Betsy DiSalvo. "The Post-Builder Perspective: Recognizing the Computing Work & Labor of Everyday People." *Under review for CHI 2027.*

Lara Karki, Idel Martinez-Ramos, Sabine Verdult, Dana Priest, Asher Brown, Felienne Hermans, and Betsy DiSalvo. "Epistemologies of Programming." *Submitted to CSCW.*

Lara Karki, Asher Brown, Daba Priest, Joshua Fortier, Briana Evans-Lopez, Oschaya Ellis, Justin Booker, and Betsy DiSalvo. "Research through Career Development." *Anticipated submission to CHIWORK 2027.*

Presentations

Invited Talks

Are LLMs making me dumber?, Allegheny County Department of Human Services, Pittsburgh, PA 2026

Cognition and LLMs, Responsible AI Group, Merck, Rahway, NJ 2025

Platform Delivered Microaggressions on LinkedIn, STS Symposium at Georgia Tech, Atlanta, GA 2023

Generative Art with FizzBuzz in CSS (workshop), CodeDay, Online 2021
https://notlaura.com/speaking/generative-art-with-fizzbuzz-in-css/

Algorithms in CSS, CSS Day, Amsterdam, Netherlands 2019
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dtddBM8s7xY

CSS Is a Programming Language, WordCamp Montclair, Montclair, NJ 2019
https://montclair.wordcamp.org/2019/session/css-is-a-programming-language/

Understanding Today's CSS with Algorithms, SIGNAL (Twilio), San Francisco, CA 2018
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=x2lXsk3yhOY

Guest Lectures

LLMs and Creative Practice, Creative Design Practice (CS 8803), Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA 2026

Academic Websites, Intro to Ph.D. Studies (CS 8803), Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA 2025

Conference Presentations

Recognizing, Supporting, and Futuring Diverse Pathways in Computing, CHIWORK 2026, Linz, Austria 2026
https://doi.org/10.1145/3805029.3818267

Platform Delivered Microaggressions on LinkedIn, CSCW 2025, Bergen, Norway 2025
https://doi.org/10.1145/3757413

A Window into DataWorks, SIGCSE TS 2025, Pittsburgh, PA 2025
https://doi.org/10.1145/3641554.3701826

Re-thinking Skill in Times of Technological Change, Critical Computing Group, Atlanta, GA 2024

Novice-Friendly Computational Work: Getting Past the Gatekeepers (lightning talk), ICER 2023, Chicago, IL 2023

CSS Algorithms, Strange Loop, St. Louis, MO 2019
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dxY5CdZNzsk

Is CSS a Programming Language?, Abstractions II, Pittsburgh, PA 2019
https://noti.st/laras126/N9gy9e

CSS Algorithms, JSConf US, San Diego, CA 2019
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=panKf9hzUfQ

Writing CSS Algorithms, CSS Camp, Barcelona, Spain 2019
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LPuLoB-eJYw

Bridging the Gap Between Design & Development with CSS Algorithms, WordCamp US, Nashville, TN 2018
https://wordpress.tv/2018/12/30/lara-schenck-bridging-the-design-and-development-gap-with-css-algorithms/

The Algorithms of CSS, CSSConf EU, Berlin, Germany 2018
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cCeqH6m_K20

Gutenberg Q&A Panel (panelist) and co-organizer, WordCamp Los Angeles, Los Angeles, CA 2018
https://wordpress.tv/2019/01/02/panel-gutenberg-q-and-a/

Let's Build a Gutenberg Block Workshop, WordCamp Europe, Belgrade, Serbia 2018
https://wordpress.tv/2018/08/07/lara-schenck-lets-build-a-gutenberg-block/

Let's Build a Gutenberg Block, WordCamp San Diego, San Diego, CA 2018
https://sandiego.wordcamp.org/2018/session/lets-build-a-gutenberg-block/

The Five-Figure WordPress Website, Abstractions, Pittsburgh, PA 2016

Vetting and Choosing Themes, WordCamp Pittsburgh, Pittsburgh, PA 2016
https://wordpress.tv/2016/10/06/lara-schenck-vetting-choosing-themes/

Why the Designer Failed FizzBuzz, SassConf, Austin, TX 2015

Vetting and Choosing Premium Themes, WordCamp NYC, New York, NY 2015
https://wordpress.tv/2015/12/22/lara-schenck-vetting-and-choosing-premium-themes/

Sassy WordPress, WordCamp Montreal, Montreal, Canada 2014
https://wordpress.tv/2015/05/30/lara-schenck-sassy-wordpress/

Freelancing, Real Talk, WordCamp NYC, New York, NY 2014

Meetup and Community Talks

Race and Technology, WHAT'S UP?! Pittsburgh, Pittsburgh, PA 2020

Is CSS a Programming Language? (talk preview), Code & Supply, Pittsburgh, PA 2019

The Algorithms of CSS, js.la, Los Angeles, CA 2018
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Vckubc40dsM

Sass for WordPress, Hollywood WordPress Meetup, Los Angeles, CA 2017

Intro to Coding for WordPress, WordPress NYC Meetup, New York, NY 2016
https://www.meetup.com/wordpressnyc/events/231798132/

Vetting and Choosing Premium Themes, WordPress NYC Meetup, New York, NY 2016
https://www.meetup.com/wordpressnyc/events/228551568/

Problems with Job Titles and Descriptions, Sass NYC, New York, NY 2015

Tales of a Non-Unicorn, CodePen NYC Meetup, New York, NY 2015

Sass – CSS With Superpowers, WordPress NYC Meetup, New York, NY 2015
https://wordpress.tv/2015/06/28/lara-schenck-sass-css-with-superpowers/

Child Themes: A Crash Course, WordPress NYC Meetup, New York, NY 2014
https://notlaura.com/child-themes-talk-nyc-wp-meetup/

Doctoral Consortia and Workshop Participation

Sustaining Work-Based Learning and Middle-Skill Jobs in an AI-Impacted Workforce, Future Leaders of AI Doctoral Consortium, ACM AI Leadership Summit, Atlanta, GA 2026

Can AI Rebuild Middle-Wage Jobs?, Critical Futures of Work Workshop, CSCW 2025, Bergen, Norway 2025

Novice-Friendly Computational Work: Getting Past the Gatekeepers, CRA Women in Computing, San Francisco, CA 2023

Other Scholarly and Creative Work

Author, notlaura.com. Personal technical blog on CSS, front-end development, WordPress, and computing careers research. Widely shared CSS writing (2015–2017) that led to international conference speaking invitations. 2009–2022. Selected articles:

"How to write and run a shell script." March 16, 2022. https://notlaura.com/how-to-write-and-run-shell-scripts/

"Email template for requesting an informational interview from someone you never met." https://notlaura.com/email-template-for-requesting-an-informational-interview-from-someone-you-never-met/

"Is CSS Turing complete?" May 25, 2019. https://notlaura.com/is-css-turing-complete/

"Writing CSS algorithms." February 18, 2019. https://notlaura.com/writing-css-algorithms/

"CSS is a declarative, domain-specific programming language." October 7, 2018. https://notlaura.com/css-is-a-programming-language/

"Browser mechanics in my own words, part 2: The browser is an interpreter." July 15, 2018. https://notlaura.com/browser-mechanics-in-my-own-words-part-2-the-browser-is-an-interpreter/

"Browser mechanics in my own words, part 1: Decode bytes to Unicode code points." July 8, 2018. https://notlaura.com/browser-mechanics-in-my-own-words-part-1-bytes-to-unicode-code-points/

"What is PHP output buffering?" October 21, 2017. https://notlaura.com/output-buffering/

"The Twig for Timber cheatsheet." October 16, 2015. https://notlaura.com/the-twig-for-timber-cheatsheet/

"Show a title when hovering over an image with jQuery or CSS." February 5, 2014. https://notlaura.com/show-title-hovering-image/

"A template for analyzing game design." November 16, 2012. https://notlaura.com/a-template-for-analyzing-game-design/

Guest Author, CSS-Tricks. Widely read industry blog publishing technical front-end development content.

"We are programmers." November 22, 2019. https://css-tricks.com/we-are-programmers/

"Learning Gutenberg: A primer with create-guten-block." May 22, 2018. https://css-tricks.com/learning-gutenberg-3-primer-with-create-guten-block/

"Learning Gutenberg: What is Gutenberg, anyway?" May 21, 2018. https://css-tricks.com/learning-gutenberg-2-what-is-gutenberg/

"Tales of a non-unicorn: A story about the roller coaster of job searching." January 8, 2018. https://css-tricks.com/tales-non-unicorn-story-roller-coaster-job-searching/

"Advocating for accessible UI design." November 21, 2017. https://css-tricks.com/advocating-for-accessible-ui-design/

"Tales of a non-unicorn: A story about the trouble with job titles and descriptions." May 11, 2015. https://css-tricks.com/tales-of-a-non-unicorn-a-story-about-the-trouble-with-job-titles-and-descriptions/

Interviews and Media

"SIGCSE 2025." Research highlight on DataWorks, Georgia Tech Research Impact & Leadership. 2025. https://sites.gatech.edu/research/sigcse-2025/#karki

"Ph.D. Students Earn NSF Graduate Fellowships Through Responsible Computing." Feature, Georgia Tech College of Computing News. 2023. https://www.cc.gatech.edu/news/phd-students-earn-nsf-graduate-fellowships-through-responsible-computing

"Lara Schenck on CSS Algorithms and Turd-Driven Development." Podcast interview, React Podcast, Episode 68. October 17, 2019. https://reactpodcast.com/68

"Declaration – CSS, Music, Components." Podcast interview, TalkScript, Episode 45. September 2019. https://talkscript.sitepen.com/?p=19092

"The Value of HTML and CSS with Mandy Michael and Lara Schenck." Podcast interview, ShopTalk Show, Episode 284. 2017. https://shoptalkshow.com/284-value-html-css-mandy-michael-lara-schenck/

"WordPress Development, Freelancing, and Taking Time Off." Podcast interview, The Versioning Show (SitePoint). 2017. https://www.sitepoint.com/wordpress-development-freelancing-taking-time-off-lara-schenck/

Podcast interview, ShopTalk Show, Episode 171. June 22, 2015. https://shoptalkshow.com/171-with-lara-schenck/

"Road to Sass Conf." Podcast interview, Sass Bites. 2015. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=awOuC1W5wvY

"Lara Schenck: Designer/developer/consultant." Interview, Workspiration. January 30, 2015. https://workspiration.org/lara-schenck

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record

Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA

- Cognitive Science & LLMs (CS 8001; 73 students) — May 2026 – Aug 2026
- Research Seminar (CS 8903)
  - AI & Hiring (10 students across 3+ terms) — Aug 2025 – Present
  - Software Engineering Labor Conditions (1 student) — Aug 2026 – Present
  - DataWorks Business Development (2 students) — Aug 2026 – Present

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA

- Creative Design Practice (CS 8803); Instructor: Carl DiSalvo — Jan 2026 – May 2026
- Intro to Ph.D. Studies (CS 8803); Instructor: Betsy DiSalvo — Aug 2025 – Dec 2025

Curriculum Development

Cognitive Science & LLMs — 2026
https://laras126.github.io/cog-sci-and-llms/

Career Development — 2022
https://dataworkforce.gatech.edu/data-tools/career-development-curriculum/

Generative Art with FizzBuzz in CSS Workshop — 2020
https://notlaura.com/speaking/generative-art-with-fizzbuzz-in-css/

Gutenberg Blocks Workshop — 2018
https://laras126.github.io/wceu-2018/

Computer Science Bootcamp — 2017
https://notlaura.com/prepare-flood-posts-computer-science-basics/

UI Prototyping in Code — 2015 – 2016
https://uipicspring16.wordpress.com/category/class-plan/

Additional Teaching

DataWorks @ Georgia Tech, *Career Development Founder & Facilitator,* Atlanta, GA 2022 – 2025

Westinghouse High School, *TEALS Computer Science Classroom Support Volunteer,* Pittsburgh, PA 2021 – 2022

University of Southern California, *Adjunct Instructor,* WordPress Development, Los Angeles, CA 2018

Girl Develop It, Multiple workshops, National 2015 – 2018

Pratt Institute of Design, *Adjunct Instructor,* UI/UX Prototyping in Code, Coding I–II, New York, NY 2015 – 2016

CSS-Tricks, *Office Hours Instructor,* Online 2015

Decoded, *Executive Education Facilitator,* Code in a Day, New York, NY 2014 – 2016

General Assembly, *Lead Instructor,* Front-End Web Development, New York, NY 2013 – 2014

Saxifrage School, *Co-Instructor,* Front-End Web Development, Pittsburgh, PA 2012

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Merck, *Commercial AI Capabilities Intern,* Rahway, NJ Jun 2025 – Aug 2025

- Developed human-centered AI framework and study protocols from interviews and ethnographic research with 25+ stakeholders; presented to AI Leadership and Responsible AI teams (100+).

Penske Media Corporation, *Principal Software Engineer,* Los Angeles, CA Jun 2018 – May 2022

- Created design system and component architecture, leading all stages from protype to production; deployed across 5 brands, improving migration productivity 60%. Conducted survey and interview study with 15+ product, design, and engineering stakeholders, and led change management across 80+ person product team.

Independent Consulting, *Founder & Technical Consultant,* Pittsburgh, PA and New York, NY Aug 2011 – Jun 2018

- Provided design, development, and technical training to 30+ clients, including The Weather Channel and Barnes & Noble, start ups, individuals and small businesses.
- Established thought leadership, speaking at 19+ international industry conferences (audiences of 500+ and 40k+ recording views), developed and taught online courses, and published tutorials online.

Institute of Play, *Design Assistant,* New York, NY Sep 2013 – Jun 2014

- Designed digital and non-digital game assets and curricular materials for the Mission Lab at Quest to Learn, a New York City public middle and high school focused on systems thinking and game-like learning; collaborated with game designers and educators.

onlyinpgh, *Lead UI/UX Designer and Developer,* Pittsburgh, PA Sep 2011 – Oct 2012

- Designed web and iOS versions of Scenable, an app for local communities; built the front end in Django and contributed to company strategy on a small team.

RESEARCH MENTORING

Elizabeth Jamison, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech 2026 – Present

Austin Fulbright, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech 2026 – Present

Grace Gong, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech 2026 – Present

Justin W. Thomas, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech 2026 – Present

Alicia N. Bochnak, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech 2025 – Present

Marine Regnault, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech 2025 – Present

James T. Roberts, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech 2025 – Present

Yashika Reddy, B.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech 2025 – Present
Asher Brown, Data Fellow, DataWorks, Georgia Tech 2024 – Present
Dana Priest, Training Coordinator, DataWorks, Georgia Tech 2022 – Present
Saurabh Kalia, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech 2025 – 2026
Kunyeul Lee, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech 2026
Minhaz Jisan, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech 2026
Eric Oliphant, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech 2026
Ding (Dean) Ding Tian, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech 2025
Alésandra Baca-Vazques, Ph.D. Human-Centered Computing, Georgia Tech 2025

SERVICE

Academic Service

Lead Organizer, Workshop at CHIWORK 2026, Linz, Austria 2026
Co-Organizer, ATL Pre-CHI Event, Atlanta SIGCHI Chapter, Atlanta, GA 2026

Reviewer

ACM SIGCHI Conference on Computer-Human Interaction 2025, 2027
ACM International Conference on Supporting Group Work 2026
Transactions on Computing Education Research 2023, 2025, 2026
Computer Supported Cooperative Work (CSCW) 2025
ACM SIGCSE Conference on Computer Science Education 2024, 2025
ACM Conference on Designing Interactive Systems 2023

University Service

Founder, HCC Writing Group, Georgia Institute of Technology 2023 – Present
Co-Founder & Mentor, "IC Buddies" Ph.D. Mentor Program, Georgia Institute of Technology 2025 – Present
Participant, GVU Showcase, Institute for People and Technology, Georgia Institute of Technology 2023 – 2025

Community Service

Next Steps Volunteer Facilitator, Atlanta Mission, Atlanta, GA 2026 – Present
Technical Advisor, Supreme Network Global, Pittsburgh, PA 2021 – Present

- Advise CEO of a membership network empowering formerly incarcerated people with financial and mentorship opportunities.

Volunteer Web Developer, Center for Artistic Activism (C4AA) 2020 – 2022
Volunteer Web Developer, Cool Cars for Kids 2019

Industry Service

Open Source Contributor, WordPress Core 2011 – 2022

- Facilitated weekly Core CSS team meetings overseeing long-term projects to improve the maintainability of the WordPress Core CSS codebase.
- Contributed code updates to WordPress Core.
- Organized community meetups and conferences that sustain and grow the open-source community.

Mentor, Learn Teach Code, Los Angeles, CA and Online 2017 – 2021
Co-Organizer, Global Diversity CFP Day, Pittsburgh, PA 2019

Mentor & Volunteer Organizer, Write/Speak/Code, Los Angeles, CA	2017 – 2019
Founder & Lead Organizer, CSS.la Meetup, Los Angeles, CA	2018 – 2019
Mentor, Global Diversity CFP Day, Los Angeles, CA	2018
Co-Organizer, WordCamp LA, Los Angeles, CA	2018
HelpDesk Volunteer, WordCamp NYC, Nashville	2018
Volunteer Facilitator, Women Who Code, New York, NY	2016 – 201[?]
Founder & Lead Organizer, CodePen NYC Meetup, New York, NY	2014 – 2016
Mentor & Regular Presenter, WordPress NYC Meetup, New York, NY	2013 – 2016